Theme 2: Starting University

Goodbye, School! (Reading speed)

Lesson 2-1
Book pages 17-19

💡 **Big idea:** Starting university is a major **transition**. It is normal to feel **apprehensive**, but there are simple **tips** to cope: look after yourself, balance study and fun, ask for help, and make new friends. We practise **reading for gist** and **reading speed**.

🎯 **I will learn:**

- Read for gist without understanding every word
- Calculate and improve reading speed
- Find words with similar meanings
- Discuss feelings about leaving school

📖 Key words

transition انتقال / مرحلة تحول	**apprehensive** قلق ومتخوف	**homesick** مشتاق إلى البيت	**campus** الحرم الجامعي
prioritise يرتب حسب الأهمية	**deadline** موعد نهائي	**emotions** مشاعر	**independence** استقلالية
prospects فرص مستقبلية	**rewarding** مُجزٍ		

Tips for new students

- Take care of yourself: sleep and eat healthy food
- Balance relaxing and studying
- Call home regularly to reduce homesickness
- Ask for help from students, tutors or support services
- Learn your way around the campus
- Make a plan and manage your time
- prioritise urgent tasks
- Don't be hard on yourself
- learn from mistakes
- Join clubs and societies to make friends

Challenges and rewards

- University can be challenging and you may feel stress
- You develop confidence and independence
- Many people regard university as the best time of their lives

Tips for new students

1. Take care of yourself physically. Get enough sleep and eat healthy foods.
2. Find a balance between relaxing and studying. You should work hard but also have fun.
3. Call home regularly and keep in touch with your family. This will reduce homesickness.
4. Don't be afraid to ask for help. If you're finding things hard, talk to someone – other students, tutors (teachers), or student support services.
5. Learn how to find your way around the university campus so that you don't get lost. Refer to the university website if necessary.
6. Make a plan for yourself which shows where you have to be every day, and at what time.

Tips for new students (p.18)

✏️ Examples

Find a word in the text meaning 'worried and a little afraid'.

Answer: apprehensive

What advice is given to shy students?

Answer: Take opportunities to make new friends and join clubs and societies.

⭐ Remember

- Reading speed = number of words ÷ minutes. Don't stop at every new word
- guess from context.

⚠️ Watch out

- ✗ Checking every word in the dictionary while skimming ✓ Read for the gist first

🧩 **Activity:** Rank the tips from most to least important and compare your list in a group.

✅ Check yourself

1. What is 'homesick'?
2. What does 'prioritise' mean?
3. How can you reduce homesickness?
4. What does 'campus' mean?

Answers: (1) feeling sad because you miss your home ، (2) put things in order of importance ، (3) call home regularly ، (4) university land and buildings